

Disaster Response Platform

User Manual

Audience: Program coordinators, field responders, partners, logistics staff, and admins

Purpose: Operate the MVP disaster response coordination workspace

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1. What This App Is For

The Disaster Response Platform gives response teams one shared place to manage programs, field needs, tasks, resources, partner activity, maps, budgets, and situation reports. It is designed for operational clarity during fast-moving response work.

Core outcomes

- See active programs, affected people, open needs, teams, and resource gaps.
- Submit and verify field needs with location, urgency, quantity, and notes.
- Assign tasks and track status through response follow-up.
- Track inventory, commitments, teams, and partner 3W activity.
- Generate, review, audit, and export situation reports.

2. User Roles

Admin: Full access to admin, users, organizations, and operational data.

Coordinator: Manages programs, tasks, resources, reports, and review workflows.

Responder: Submits needs and updates assigned task status.

Partner: Updates partner 3W activity where available.

Viewer: Reads dashboards, maps, and reports without mutation access.

Note: Current MVP auth uses demo cookie sessions. Production deployments should replace this with the selected identity provider and enforce route-level protection.

3. Navigation

- Dashboard: common operating picture and current response summary.
- Programs: program list, creation flow, detail pages, and operational workflow

tabs.

- Map: shared operational map with program, need, resource, team, and partner layers.
- Deployment: logistics workspace for teams and resource commitments.
- SitReps: saved situation reports and export links.
- Admin: demo users, roles, and organizations.

4. Program Workflow

1. Open Programs and choose New Program.
2. Enter title, disaster type, location, coordinates, status, severity, and description.
3. Add master budget, sub-program allocations, and initial fund requests when relevant.
4. Save the program and confirm it appears on the dashboard and map.
5. Use the program detail page to coordinate needs, tasks, resources, partners, and reports.

Budget guardrails

The master budget is the program-level financial control. Sub-program allocations and fund requests should remain within that control amount. If a fund request would exceed the available balance, adjust the request or update the program budget through the approved process.

5. Needs And Tasks

1. Responder submits a need with category, location, urgency, quantity, affected people, and notes.
2. Coordinator reviews and verifies the need.
3. Coordinator creates a task, assigns it to a team, and sets priority and due date.
4. Responder updates task status as work progresses.
5. Coordinator reviews gaps and closes out fulfilled needs and completed tasks.

Note: Use concise notes that explain what changed, what is blocked, and what support is needed. Avoid sensitive personal data unless policy allows it.

6. Resources, Teams, And Partners

- Use Deployment to review available resources, committed quantities, teams, and

assigned programs.

- Create or update resources with category, stock, unit, warehouse location, and assignment.
- Commit resources only when stock is available and the operational need is verified.
- Use partner activity records to track who is doing what, where, and current status.

7. Operational Map

The map shows programs, needs, resources, teams, and partner activities. Use layer toggles and filters for program, urgency, status, and organization to narrow the view. Empty results are expected when filters are restrictive.

- Programs show the primary response location.
- Needs show reported field demand by location.
- Resources and teams are offset near their assigned program when they do not have independent coordinates.
- Partner markers show 3W activity and status.

8. Situation Reports

1. Open a program detail page and go to SitReps.
2. Create a manual SitRep or generate an AI-assisted draft from current program data.
3. Review all AI-generated text before saving it as an official record.
4. Use status controls to move reports through draft, submitted, approved, or rejected states.
5. Export approved or reviewed reports as operational, donor, or executive text/PDF variants.

Operational export: Full working report for response coordination.

Donor export: Fundraising- and support-oriented language and section labels.

Executive export: Shorter decision-focused variant for leadership review.

9. Audit History

Core operational mutations record audit entries with actor, action, entity, timestamp, and before/after summaries. Program detail pages surface recent operational and SitRep audit activity so coordinators can trace important changes.

10. Troubleshooting

Cannot save: Check required fields, role permissions, and whether the current user is signed in.

No map results: Clear filters or enable hidden layers.

Missing data: Confirm the selected `DATA_BACKEND` and seed data for the environment.

AI draft unavailable: Check server-side `OPENAI_API_KEY` and route logs. Never expose the key as `NEXT_PUBLIC`.

Export issue: Try the text export first, then regenerate the PDF variant.

11. What's Next

- Replace demo auth with production identity and route protection.
- Harden validation, empty states, loading states, and form feedback.
- Add SitRep editing for saved records and complete approval UX polish.
- Run accessibility and mobile layout reviews for field workflows.
- Add PostGIS, Leaflet, or Mapbox only when advanced map requirements justify the extra infrastructure.